CASE STUDY | CRM & JOB MANAGEMENT AUTOMATION

Getting New Leads to the Right Person, Instantly

CRM to ServiceM8 automation for an HVAC business

INDUSTRY	LOCATION	TOOLS
HVAC & Refrigeration	Newcastle, NSW, Australia	LeadConnector (GoHighLevel), Zapier, ServiceM8 API

The Client

A growing HVAC and refrigeration business that runs its sales pipeline in LeadConnector and manages jobs, quoting and field work in ServiceM8. Most of its leads come from Facebook Ads and move through a pipeline from first contact to site inspection, quote and follow-up.

The Challenge

The business already had an automation that pushed leads from the CRM into ServiceM8 when they reached a "Send to ServiceM8" stage. In practice, it had gaps that were costing the owner time and confidence.

- **Silent arrivals.** New jobs landed in ServiceM8 with no notification, so the owner had to search for each lead by name to confirm it had come through.
- **Repeat customers broke it.** ServiceM8 requires unique client names, so a returning customer or duplicate name stopped the whole automation. No job was created, and nobody knew.
- **No home for new leads.** Jobs were mixed in with everything else instead of sitting in a dedicated queue for new enquiries.
- **Messy client names.** First and last names were joined without a space ("JohnSmith"), making records harder to find and unprofessional.

The Solution

We rebuilt the automation so that every new lead lands in a dedicated queue, is assigned to the owner, and triggers an instant notification on his phone.

The standard ServiceM8 integration in Zapier only supports two basic actions, creating a client and creating a job, with no option for queues or staff allocation. To get past that, we built custom API actions that talk directly to ServiceM8. One assigns each new job to the right staff member in a defined time window, which triggers ServiceM8's native push notification. The other places each job into a new "Leads" queue the client created, so every new enquiry sits in one organised place.

We also restructured the workflow so it can't be blocked by duplicates. The job is now created, allocated and queued *before* the client record step. If a customer already exists in ServiceM8, the job still goes through and the owner still gets notified.

The final workflow

1	A lead is moved to the "Send to ServiceM8" stage in the CRM.
2	A job is created in ServiceM8 with the customer's details.
3	The job is allocated to the owner, who gets an instant notification.
4	The job is moved into the Leads queue.
5	The client record is created, if it doesn't already exist.

We also fixed the name formatting so client records come through cleanly ("John Smith"), and confirmed the trigger only fires from the correct pipeline stage, so leads moving between other stages don't create duplicate jobs.

The Results

The client tested the new workflow the same day and confirmed it worked end to end. A test lead moved in the CRM appeared in the new queue, assigned to him, with a notification on his phone within moments.

1 afternoon	Instant	0
from request to live, tested solution	owner notification on every new lead	leads lost to duplicate-name errors

- The owner is notified the moment a lead is sent across, with no more manual searching.
- Every new enquiry lives in one dedicated queue instead of being scattered through ServiceM8.
- Repeat customers no longer cause failures, so no lead is lost to a duplicate-name error.
- Client records are clean and searchable, with names formatted properly.

Why it matters
For a trade business, speed to lead is everything. A lead that sits unnoticed for a day is often a lead lost to a competitor. By closing the gap between the CRM and the job management system, the owner now knows about every new enquiry the moment it's ready to action, and his team works from one organised view.